

Package ‘broadcast’

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Title 'Numpy'-

Like Broadcasted Operations for Atomic and Recursive Arrays with Minimal Dependencies

Version 0.0.0.9002

Description Implements simple broadcasted operations for atomic and recursive arrays.

Besides linking to 'Rcpp',

'broadcast' does not depend on, vendor, link to, include, or otherwise use any external libraries;

'broadcast' was essentially made from scratch and can be installed out-of-the-box.

The implementations available in 'broadcast' include, but are not limited to, the following.

1) A set of type-specific functions for broadcasted element-wise operations on any 2 arrays;
they support a large set of relational-, arithmetic-, Boolean-, and string operations.

2) A faster, more memory efficient, and broadcasted version of `abind()`,
for binding arrays along an arbitrary dimension;

3) Broadcasted ifelse- and apply-like functions;

4) The `acast()` function, for casting/pivoting an array into a new dimension.

The functions in the 'broadcast' package strive to minimize computation time and memory usage
(which is not just good for efficient computing, but also for the environment).

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BugReports <https://github.com/tony-aw/broadcast/issues/>

Language en-gb

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aaa00_broadcast_help	<i>broadcast: 'Numpy'-like Broadcasted Operations for Atomic and Recursive Arrays with Minimal Dependencies</i>
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Description

broadcast:

Simple Broadcasted Binding and Binary Operations for Atomic and Recursive Arrays with Minimal Dependencies.

Implements simple broadcasted operations for atomic and recursive arrays.

Besides linking to 'Rcpp', 'broadcast' does not depend on, vendor, link to, include, or otherwise use any external libraries; 'broadcast' was essentially made from scratch and can be installed out-of-the-box.

The implementations available in 'broadcast' include, but are not limited to, the following:

1. A set of type-specific functions for broadcasted element-wise operations on any 2 arrays; they support a large set of relational-, arithmetic-, Boolean-, and string operations.
2. A faster, more memory efficient, and broadcasted version of `abind()`, for binding arrays along an arbitrary dimension;
3. Broadcasted `ifelse`- and `apply`-like functions;
4. The `acast()` function, for casting/pivoting an array into a new dimension.

The functions in the 'broadcast' package strive to minimize computation time and memory usage (which is not just good for efficient computing, but also for the environment).

Getting Started

An introduction and overview of the package can be found [HERE](#).

Note that 'broadcast' is still somewhat experimental; if you find bugs or other issues, please report them promptly on the 'broadcast' GitHub [issues tab](#).

Functions

Functions for broadcasted element-wise binary operations

'broadcast' provides a set of functions for broadcasted element-wise binary operations with broadcasting.

These functions use an API similar to the [outer](#) function.

The following functions for type-specific binary operations are available:

- [bc.b](#): Boolean operations;
- [bc.i](#): integer (53bit) arithmetic and relational operations;
- [bc.d](#): decimal (64bit) arithmetic and relational operations;
- [bc.cplx](#): complex arithmetic and (in)equality operations;
- [bc.str](#): string (in)equality, concatenation, and distance operations;
- [bc.raw](#): for raw arrays; bit-wise operations and (in)equality operations;
- [bc.list](#): apply any 'R' function to 2 recursive arrays with broadcasting.

`bind_array()`

'broadcast' provides the [bind_array](#) function, to bind arrays along an arbitrary dimension, with support for broadcasting.

The API of `bind_array()` is inspired by the fantastic `abind::abind()` function by Tony Plare & Richard Heiberger (2016).

But `bind_array()` differs considerably from `abind::abind` in the following ways:

- `bind_array()` differs from `abind::abind` in that it can handle recursive arrays properly (the `abind::abind` function would unlist everything to atomic arrays, ruining the structure).
- `bind_array()` allows for broadcasting, while `abind::abind` does not support broadcasting.
- `bind_array()` is generally faster than `abind::abind`, as `bind_array()` relies heavily on 'C' and 'C++' code.
- unlike `abind::abind`, `bind_array()` only binds (atomic/recursive) arrays and matrices. `bind_array()` does not attempt to convert things to arrays when they are not arrays, but will give an error instead.
This saves computation time and prevents unexpected results.
- `bind_array()` has more streamlined naming options, compared to `abind::abind`.

General functions

'broadcast' also comes with 2 general broadcasted functions:

- [bc.ifelse](#): Broadcasted version of [ifelse](#).
- [bc.apply](#): Broadcasted apply-like function.

Other functions

'broadcast' provides the [acast](#) function, for casting (i.e. pivoting) an array into a new dimension.

'broadcast' also provides [type-casting](#) functions, which preserve names and dimensions - convenient for arrays.

Overloading

Sometimes broadcasting is needed in large mathematical expression, involving multiple variables, where precedence is of importance.

For example in an expression like $(x + y) / z^y$.

For such cases, you may want to overload the base operators.

The 'broadcast' package provides 2 ways to overload base operators to support broadcasting:

1. Via the [bc_chain](#) function, to evaluate a mathematical expression using overloaded operators for broadcast support.
2. Via the [broadcaster](#) class, which comes with its own method dispatch for the base operators.

The following base operators can be overloaded via either method:

- From [bc.num](#) and [bc.cplx](#): +, -, *, /, ^
- From [bc.i](#): %%, %/%%
- From [bc.b](#) and [bc.raw](#): &, |

Overloads for the relational operators (==, !=, etc.) have not yet been implemented; this will be done soon.

Author(s)

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References

Plate T, Heiberger R (2016). *abind: Combine Multidimensional Arrays*. R package version 1.4-5, <https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=abind>.

acast

Simple and Fast Casting/Pivoting of an Array

Description

The `acast()` function spreads subsets of an array margin over a new dimension.

Written in 'C' and 'C++' for high speed and memory efficiency.

Roughly speaking, `acast()` can be thought of as the "array" analogy to `data.table::dcast()`. But note 2 important differences:

- `acast()` works on arrays instead of `data.tables`.
- `acast()` casts into a completely new dimension (namely `ndim(x) + 1`), instead of casting into new columns.

Usage

```
acast(
  x,
  margin,
  grp,
  fill = FALSE,
  fill_val = if (is.atomic(x)) NA else list(NULL)
)
```

Arguments

<code>x</code>	an atomic or recursive array.
<code>margin</code>	a scalar integer, specifying the margin to cast from.
<code>grp</code>	a factor, where <code>length(grp) == dim(x)[margin]</code> , with at least 2 unique values, specifying which indices of <code>dim(x)[margin]</code> belong to which group. Each group will be cast onto a separate index of dimension <code>ndim(x) + 1</code> . Unused levels of <code>grp</code> will be dropped. Any NA values or levels found in <code>grp</code> will result in an error.
<code>fill</code>	Boolean. When factor <code>grp</code> is unbalanced (i.e. has unequally sized groups) the result will be an array where some slices have missing values, which need to be filled. If <code>fill = TRUE</code> , an unbalanced <code>grp</code> factor is allowed, and missing values will be filled with <code>fill_val</code> . If <code>fill = FALSE</code> (default), an unbalanced <code>grp</code> factor is not allowed, and providing an unbalanced factor for <code>grp</code> produces an error. When <code>x</code> has type of <code>raw</code> , unbalanced <code>grp</code> is never allowed.
<code>fill_val</code>	scalar of the same type of <code>x</code> , giving value to use to fill in the gaps when <code>fill = TRUE</code> . The <code>fill_val</code> argument is ignored when <code>fill = FALSE</code> or when <code>x</code> has type of <code>raw</code> .

Details

For the sake of illustration, consider a matrix `x` and a grouping factor `grp`. Let the integer scalar `k` represent a group in `grp`, such that $k \in 1:nlevels(grp)$. Then the code

```
out = acast(x, margin = 1, grp = grp)
```

essentially performs the following for every group `k`:

- copy-paste the subset `x[grp == k, ]` to the subset `out[, , k]`.

Please see the examples section to get a good idea on how this function casts an array. A more detailed explanation of the `acast()` function can be found on the website.

Value

An array with the following properties:

- the number of dimensions of the output array is equal to `ndim(x) + 1`;
- the dimensions of the output array is equal to `c(dim(x), max(tabulate(grp)))`;

- the dimnames of the output array is equal to `c(dimnames(x), list(levels(grp)))`.

Back transformation

From the casted array,
`out = acast(x, margin, grp)`,
 one can get the original `x` back by using
`back = asplit(out, ndim(out)) |> bind_array(along = margin)`.
 Note, however, the following about the back-transformed array `back`:

- `back` will be ordered by `grp` along dimension `margin`;
- if the levels of `grp` did not have equal frequencies, then `dim(back)[margin] > dim(x)[margin]`, and `back` will have more missing values than `x`.

Examples

```
x <- cbind(id = c(rep(1:3, each = 2), 1), grp = c(rep(1:2, 3), 2), val = rnorm(7))
print(x)

grp <- as.factor(x[, 2])
levels(grp) <- c("a", "b")
margin <- 1L

acast(x, margin, grp, fill = TRUE)
```

bc.b

Broadcasted Boolean Operations

Description

The `bc.b()` function performs broadcasted Boolean operations on 2 logical (or 32bit integer) arrays.

Please note that these operations will treat the input as Boolean.

Therefore, something like `bc.b(1, 2, "==")` returns `TRUE`, because both 1 and 2 are `TRUE` when cast as Boolean.

Usage

```
bc.b(x, y, op)
```

Arguments

<code>x, y</code>	conformable logical (or 32bit integer) arrays.
<code>op</code>	a single string, giving the operator. Supported Boolean operators: <code>&</code> , <code> </code> , <code>xor</code> , <code>nand</code> , <code>==</code> , <code>!=</code> , <code><</code> , <code>></code> , <code><=</code> , <code>>=</code> .

Value

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted Boolean operation.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
x.data <- sample(c(TRUE, FALSE, NA), x.len, TRUE)
x <- array(x.data, x.dim)
y <- array(1:50, c(4,1,1))

bc.b(x, y, "&")
bc.b(x, y, "|")
bc.b(x, y, "xor")
bc.b(x, y, "nand")
bc.b(x, y, "==")
bc.b(x, y, "!=")
```

bc.cplx

*Broadcasted Complex Numeric Operations***Description**

The `bc.cplx()` function performs broadcasted complex numeric operations on pairs of arrays.

Note that `bc.cplx()` uses more strict NA checks than base 'R':

If for an element of either `x` or `y`, either the real or imaginary part is NA or NaN, then the result of the operation for that element is necessarily NA.

Usage

```
bc.cplx(x, y, op)
```

Arguments

<code>x, y</code>	conformable atomic arrays of type complex.
<code>op</code>	a single string, giving the operator. Supported arithmetic operators: <code>+</code> , <code>-</code> , <code>*</code> , <code>/</code> . Supported relational operators: <code>==</code> , <code>!=</code> .

Value

For arithmetic operators:

A complex array as a result of the broadcasted arithmetic operation.

For relational operators:

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted relational comparison.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
gen <- function() sample(c(rnorm(10), NA, NA, NaN, NaN, Inf, Inf, -Inf, -Inf))
x <- array(gen() + gen() * -1i, x.dim)
y <- array(gen() + gen() * -1i, c(4,1,1))

bc.cplx(x, y, "==")
bc.cplx(x, y, "!=")

bc.cplx(x, y, "+")

bc.cplx(array(gen() + gen() * -1i), array(gen() + gen() * -1i), "==")
bc.cplx(array(gen() + gen() * -1i), array(gen() + gen() * -1i), "!=")

x <- gen() + gen() * -1i
y <- gen() + gen() * -1i
out <- bc.cplx(array(x), array(y), "*")
cbind(x, y, x*y, out)
```

bc.d

Broadcasted Decimal Numeric Operations

Description

The `bc.d()` function performs broadcasted decimal numeric operations on 2 numeric or logical arrays.

`bc.num()` is an alias for `bc.d()`.

Usage

```
bc.d(x, y, op, tol = sqrt(.Machine$double.eps))
```

```
bc.num(x, y, op, tol = sqrt(.Machine$double.eps))
```

Arguments

<code>x, y</code>	conformable logical or numeric arrays.
<code>op</code>	a single string, giving the operator. Supported arithmetic operators: <code>+</code> , <code>-</code> , <code>*</code> , <code>/</code> , <code>^</code> , <code>pmin</code> , <code>pmax</code> . Supported relational operators: <code>==</code> , <code>!=</code> , <code><</code> , <code>></code> , <code><=</code> , <code>>=</code> , <code>d==</code> , <code>d!=</code> , <code>d<</code> , <code>d></code> , <code>d<=</code> , <code>d>=</code> .
<code>tol</code>	a single number between 0 and 0.1, giving the machine tolerance to use. Only relevant for the following operators: <code>d==</code> , <code>d!=</code> , <code>d<</code> , <code>d></code> , <code>d<=</code> , <code>d>=</code> See the <code>%d==%</code> , <code>%d!=%</code> , <code>%d<%</code> , <code>%d>%</code> , <code>%d<=%</code> , <code>%d>=%</code> operators from the <code>'tinycodet'</code> package for details.

Value

For arithmetic operators:

A numeric array as a result of the broadcasted decimal arithmetic operation.

For relational operators:

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted decimal relational comparison.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
x.data <- sample(c(NA, 1.1:1000.1), x.len, TRUE)
x <- array(x.data, x.dim)
y <- array(1:50, c(4,1,1))
```

```
bc.d(x, y, "+")
bc.d(x, y, "-")
bc.d(x, y, "*")
bc.d(x, y, "/")
bc.d(x, y, "^")
```

```
bc.d(x, y, "==")
bc.d(x, y, "!=")
bc.d(x, y, "<")
bc.d(x, y, ">")
bc.d(x, y, "<=")
bc.d(x, y, ">=")
```

bc.i

Broadcasted Integer Numeric Operations with Extra Overflow Protection

Description

The `bc.i()` function performs broadcasted integer numeric operations on 2 numeric or logical arrays.

Please note that these operations will treat the input as 53bit integers, and will efficiently truncate when necessary.

Therefore, something like `bc.i(1, 1.5, "==")` returns TRUE, because `trunc(1.5)` equals 1.

Usage

```
bc.i(x, y, op)
```

Arguments

x, y	conformable logical or numeric arrays.
op	a single string, giving the operator. Supported arithmetic operators: +, -, *, gcd, %%%, %/%, ^, pmin, pmax. Supported relational operators: ==, !=, <, >, <=, >=. The "gcd" operator performs the Greatest Common Divisor" operation, using the Euclidean algorithm..

Value

For arithmetic operators:

A numeric array of whole numbers, as a result of the broadcasted arithmetic operation.

Base 'R' supports 53 bit integers, which thus range from approximately -9 quadrillion to +9 quadrillion.

Values outside of this range will be returned as -Inf or Inf, as an extra protection against integer overflow.

For relational operators:

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted integer relational comparison.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
x.data <- sample(c(NA, 1.1:1000.1), x.len, TRUE)
x <- array(x.data, x.dim)
y <- array(1:50, c(4,1,1))
```

```
bc.i(x, y, "+")
bc.i(x, y, "-")
bc.i(x, y, "*")
bc.i(x, y, "gcd") # greatest common divisor
bc.i(x, y, "^")
```

```
bc.i(x, y, "==")
bc.i(x, y, "!=")
bc.i(x, y, "<")
bc.i(x, y, ">")
bc.i(x, y, "<=")
bc.i(x, y, ">=")
```

bc.list

Broadcasted Operations for Recursive Arrays

Description

The bc.list() function performs broadcasted operations on 2 Recursive arrays.

Usage

```
bc.list(x, y, f)
```

Arguments

`x, y` conformable Recursive arrays (i.e. arrays of type `list`).
`f` a function that takes in exactly **2** arguments, and **returns** a result that can be stored in a single element of a list.

Value

A recursive array.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(c(10, 2,2))
x.len <- prod(x.dim)

gen <- function(n) sample(list(letters, month.abb, 1:10), n, TRUE)

x <- array(gen(10), x.dim)
y <- array(gen(10), c(10,1,1))

bc.list(
  x, y,
  \(x, y) c(length(x) == length(y), typeof(x) == typeof(y))
)
```

bc.raw

Broadcasted Operations on Raw Arrays

Description

The `bc.raw()` function performs broadcasted (in)equality operations and bit-wise operations on arrays of type `raw`.

Usage

```
bc.raw(x, y, op)
```

Arguments

`x, y` conformable raw vectors or arrays.
`op` a single string, giving the operator.
Supported bit-wise operators: `&`, `|`.
Supported relational operators: `==`, `!=`.

Value

For bit-wise operators:

A array of type raw, as a result of the broadcasted bit-wise operation.

For relational operators:

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted integer relational comparison.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
x.data <- as.raw(0:10)
y.data <- as.raw(10:0)
x <- array(x.data, x.dim)
y <- array(y.data, c(4,1,1))
```

```
bc.raw(x, y, "==")
bc.raw(x, y, "!=")
```

```
bc.raw(x, y, "&")
bc.raw(x, y, "|")
```

bc.str

Broadcasted String Operations

Description

The `bc.str()` function performs broadcasted string operations on pairs of arrays.

Usage

```
bc.str(x, y, op)
```

Arguments

<code>x, y</code>	conformable atomic arrays of type character.
<code>op</code>	a single string, giving the operator. Supported concatenation operators: <code>+</code> . Supported relational operators: <code>==</code> , <code>!=</code> . Supported distance operators: <code>levenshtein</code> .

Value

For concatenation operation:

A character array as a result of the broadcasted concatenation operation.

For relational operation:

A logical array as a result of the broadcasted relational comparison.

For distance operation:

An integer array as a result of the broadcasted distance measurement.

References

The 'C++' code for the Levenshtein edit string distance is based on the code found in https://rosettacode.org/wiki/Levenshtein_distance#C++

Examples

```
# string concatenation:
x <- array(letters, c(10, 2, 1))
y <- array(letters, c(10,1,1))
bc.str(x, y, "+")

# string (in)equality:
bc.str(array(letters), array(letters), "==")
bc.str(array(letters), array(letters), "!=")

# string distance (Levenshtein):
x <- array(month.name, c(12, 1))
y <- array(month.abb, c(1, 12))
out <- bc.str(x, y, "levenshtein")
dimnames(out) <- list(month.name, month.abb)
print(out)
```

bcapply

Apply a Function to 2 Broadcasted Arrays

Description

The `bcapply()` function applies a function to 2 arrays element-wise with broadcasting.

Usage

```
bcapply(x, y, f, v = NULL)
```

Arguments

<code>x, y</code>	conformable atomic or recursive arrays.
<code>f</code>	a function that takes in exactly 2 arguments, and returns a result that can be stored in a single element of a recursive or atomic array.

`v` either NULL, or single string, giving the scalar type for a single iteration.
 If NULL (default) or "list", the result will be a recursive array.
 If it is certain that, for every iteration, `f()` always results in a **single atomic scalar**, the user can specify the type in `v` to pre-allocate the result.
 Pre-allocating the results leads to slightly faster and more memory efficient code.
 NOTE: Incorrectly specifying `v` leads to undefined behaviour;
 when unsure, leave `v` at its default value.

Value

An atomic or recursive array with dimensions `bc_dim(x, y)`.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(c(10, 2,2))
x.len <- prod(x.dim)

gen <- function(n) sample(list(letters, month.abb, 1:10), n, TRUE)

x <- array(gen(10), x.dim)
y <- array(gen(10), c(10,1,1))

f <- function(x, y) list(x, y)
bcapply(x, y, f)
```

bc_chain

Evaluate a Chain of Mathematical Operations with Broadcasting

Description

The user can supply a formula giving a mathematical (-like) expression in the `bc_chain()` function. Inside `bc_chain()`, the expression is evaluated, where the base operators (+, -, *, /, etc.) have been **overloaded** to use **broadcasting**.

I.e. `bc_chain(~ x + y)` is equivalent to `bc.num(x, y, "+")`.

What sets `bc_chain()` apart from the other `bc.-`functions, other than the different syntax, is that the user can chain together multiple arithmetic operators, **with the usual mathematical precedence and bracketing rules**.

For example:

```
bc_chain(~ (x + y) / z)
```

Currently, all mathematical operators and all Boolean operators are supported, but relational operators have not yet been implemented.

Usage

```
bc_chain(f)
```

Arguments

`f` a formula giving the expression to evaluate.
 The environment of `f` is used to find the variables.
 If `environment(f)` is `NULL`, the environment from which `bc_chain()` was called is used to find the variables.

Value

The result from the broadcasted operation.

Examples

```
x <- 1:10
y <- 1:10
bc_chain(~ x + y / x)
x + 1 # mathematically equivalent to the above, since x == y
bc_chain(~ (x + y) / x)
2 * x/x # mathematically equivalent to the above, since x == y

dim(x) <- c(10, 1)
dim(y) <- c(1, 10)

bc_chain(~ x + y / x)
bc_chain(~ (x + y) / x)
bc_chain(~ ifelse(x > 1, y, x)) # ifelse and apply are not overloaded
```

bc_dim

Predict Broadcasted dimensions

Description

`bc_dim(x, y)` gives the dimensions an array would have, as the result of an broadcasted binary element-wise operation between 2 arrays `x` and `y`.

Usage

```
bc_dim(x, y)
```

Arguments

`x, y` an atomic or recursive array.

Value

Returns an integer vector giving the broadcasted dimension sizes.

Examples

```
x.dim <- c(4:2)
x.len <- prod(x.dim)
x.data <- sample(c(TRUE, FALSE, NA), x.len, TRUE)
x <- array(x.data, x.dim)
y <- array(1:50, c(4,1,1))

dim(bc.b(x, y, "&")) == bc_dim(x, y)
dim(bc.b(x, y, "|")) == bc_dim(x, y)
```

bc_ifelse

Broadcasted Ifelse

Description

The `bc_ifelse()` function performs a broadcasted form of [ifelse](#).

Usage

```
bc_ifelse(test, yes, no)
```

Arguments

test	logical vector or array with the length equal to <code>prod(bc_dim(yes, no))</code> .
yes, no	conformable arrays of the same type. All atomic types are supported except for the type of raw. Recursive arrays of type list are also supported.

Value

The output, here referred to as `out`, will be an array of the same type as `yes` and `no`.
If `test` has the same dimensions as `bc_dim(yes, no)`, then `out` will also have the same dimnames as `test`.

After broadcasting `yes` against `no`, given any element index `i`, the following will hold for the output:

- when `test[i] == TRUE`, `out[i]` is `yes[i]`;
- when `test[i] == FALSE`, `out[i]` is `no[i]`;
- when `test[i]` is `NA`, `out[i]` is `NA` when `yes` and `no` are atomic, and `out[i]` is `list(NULL)` when `yes` and `no` are recursive.

Examples

```

x.dim <- c(c(10, 2,2))
x.len <- prod(x.dim)

gen <- function(n) sample(list(letters, month.abb, 1:10), n, TRUE)

x <- array(gen(10), x.dim)
y <- array(gen(10), c(10,1,1))

cond <- bc.list(
  x, y,
  \(x, y) c(length(x) == length(y) && typeof(x) == typeof(y))
) |> as_bool()

bc_ifelse(cond, yes = x, no = y)

```

bind_array

*Dimensional Binding of Arrays with Broadcasting***Description**

bind_array() binds (atomic/recursive) arrays and (atomic/recursive) matrices.
 Returns an array.
 Allows for broadcasting.

Usage

```

bind_array(
  input,
  along,
  rev = FALSE,
  ndim2bc = 1L,
  name_along = TRUE,
  comnames_from = 1L
)

```

Arguments

input	a list of arrays; both atomic and recursive arrays are supported, and can be mixed. If argument input has length 0, or it contains exclusively objects where one or more dimensions are 0, an error is returned. If input has length 1, bind_array() simply returns input[[1L]]. input may not contain more than 2¹⁶ objects.
along	a single integer, indicating the dimension along which to bind the dimensions. I.e. use along = 1 for row-binding, along = 2 for column-binding, etc. Specifying along = 0 will bind the arrays on a new dimension before the first, making along the new first dimension. Specifying along = N + 1, with N = max(1st.ndim(input)), will create an additional dimension (N + 1) and bind the arrays along that new dimension.

rev	Boolean, indicating if along should be reversed, counting backwards. If FALSE (default), along works like normally; if TRUE, along is reversed. I.e. along = 0, rev = TRUE is equivalent to along = N+1, rev = FALSE; and along = N+1, rev = TRUE is equivalent to along = 0, rev = FALSE; with N = max(1st.ndim(input)).
ndim2bc	a single non-negative integer; specify here the maximum number of dimensions that are allowed to be broadcasted when binding arrays. If ndim2bc = 0L, no broadcasting will be allowed at all.
name_along	Boolean, indicating if dimension along should be named. Please run the code in the examples section to get a demonstration of the naming behaviour.
comnames_from	either an integer scalar or NULL. Indicates which object in input should be used for naming the shared dimension. If NULL, no communal names will be given. For example: When binding columns of matrices, the matrices will share the same rownames. Using comnames_from = 10 will then result in bind_array() using rownames(input[[10]]) for the rownames of the output.

Value

An array.

Examples

```
# Simple example ====
x <- array(1:20, c(5, 4))
y <- array(-1:-15, c(5, 3))
z <- array(21:40, c(5, 4))
input <- list(x, y, z)
# column binding:
bind_array(input, 2L)

# Mixing types ====
# here, atomic and recursive arrays are mixed,
# resulting in recursive arrays

# creating the arrays:
x <- c(
  lapply(1:3, \(x)sample(c(TRUE, FALSE, NA))),
  lapply(1:3, \(x)sample(1:10)),
  lapply(1:3, \(x)rnorm(10)),
  lapply(1:3, \(x)sample(letters))
) |> matrix(4, 3, byrow = TRUE)
dimnames(x) <- list(letters[1:4], LETTERS[1:3])
print(x)
```

```

y <- matrix(1:12, 4, 3)
print(y)
z <- matrix(letters[1:12], c(4, 3))

# column-binding:
input <- list(x = x, y = y, z = z)
bind_array(input, along = 2L)

# Illustrating `along` argument ====
# using recursive arrays for clearer visual distinction
input <- list(x = x, y = y)

bind_array(input, along = 0L) # binds on new dimension before first
bind_array(input, along = 1L) # binds on first dimension (i.e. rows)
bind_array(input, along = 2L)
bind_array(input, along = 3L) # bind on new dimension after last

bind_array(input, along = 0L, TRUE) # binds on new dimension after last
bind_array(input, along = 1L, TRUE) # binds on last dimension (i.e. columns)
bind_array(input, along = 2L, TRUE)
bind_array(input, along = 3L, TRUE) # bind on new dimension before first

# binding, with empty arrays ====
emptyarray <- array(numeric(0L), c(0L, 3L))
dimnames(emptyarray) <- list(NULL, paste("empty", 1:3))
print(emptyarray)
input <- list(x = x, y = emptyarray)
bind_array(input, along = 1L, comnames_from = 2L) # row-bind

# Illustrating `name_along` ====
x <- array(1:20, c(5, 3), list(NULL, LETTERS[1:3]))
y <- array(-1:-20, c(5, 3))
z <- array(-1:-20, c(5, 3))

bind_array(list(a = x, b = y, z), 2L)
bind_array(list(x, y, z), 2L)
bind_array(list(a = unname(x), b = y, c = z), 2L)
bind_array(list(x, a = y, b = z), 2L)
input <- list(x, y, z)
names(input) <- c("", NA, "")
bind_array(input, 2L)

```

Description

`broadcaster()` checks if an array is of class "broadcaster".
`broadcaster()<-` sets or un-sets the class attribute "broadcaster" on an array.

The broadcaster class is a simple (or "lazy") class, and exists purely to overload the math, Boolean, and relational infix operators to support broadcasting.

This makes mathematical expressions with multiple variables, where precedence may be important, far more convenient.

Like in the following calculation:

$x / (y + z)$

The broadcaster class comes with its own method dispatch for the base operators.

If at least one of the 2 arguments of the base operators is of class broadcaster, and no other class (like bit64) interferes, broadcasting will occur in the same manner as used in the various `bc.*` - functions.

Usage

```
broadcaster(x)
```

```
broadcaster(x) <- value
```

Arguments

<code>x</code>	object to check or set.
<code>value</code>	set to TRUE to make an array a broadcaster, or FALSE to remove the broadcaster class attribute from an array.

Value

For `broadcaster()`:
 TRUE if an array or vector is a broadcaster, or FALSE if it is not.

For `broadcaster()<-`:
 Returns nothing, but sets (if right hand side is TRUE) or removes (if right hand side is FALSE) the "broadcaster" class attribute.

Examples

```
x <- 1:10
broadcaster(x) <- TRUE

y <- 1:10
broadcaster(y) <- TRUE

x + y / x
x + 1 # mathematically equivalent to the above, since x == y
```

```

(x + y) / x
2 * x/x # mathematically equivalent to the above, since x == y

dim(x) <- c(10, 1)
dim(y) <- c(1, 10)

x + y / x
(x + y) / x

(x + y) * x

```

ndim	<i>Get number of dimensions</i>
------	---------------------------------

Description

ndim() returns the number of dimensions of an object.
 lst.ndim() returns the number of dimensions of every list-element.

Usage

```

ndim(x)

lst.ndim(x)

```

Arguments

x a vector or array (for ndim()), or a list of vectors/arrays (for lst.ndim()).

Value

For ndim(): an integer scalar.
 For lst.ndim(): an integer vector, with the same length, names and dimensions as x.

Examples

```

# matrix example ====
x <- list(
  array(1:10, 10),
  array(1:10, c(2, 5)),
  array(c(letters, NA), c(3,3,3))
)
lst.ndim(x)

```

rep_dim	<i>Replicate Array Dimensions</i>
---------	-----------------------------------

Description

The `rep_dim()` function replicates array dimensions until the specified dimension sizes are reached, and returns the array.

The various broadcasting functions recycle array dimensions virtually, meaning little to no additional memory is needed.

The `rep_dim()` function, however, physically replicates the dimensions of an array (and thus actually occupies additional memory space).

Usage

```
rep_dim(x, tdim)
```

Arguments

<code>x</code>	an atomic or recursive array or matrix.
<code>tdim</code>	an integer vector, giving the target dimension to reach.

Value

Returns the replicated array.

Examples

```
x <- matrix(1:9, 3,3)
colnames(x) <- LETTERS[1:3]
rownames(x) <- letters[1:3]
names(x) <- month.abb[1:9]
print(x)

rep_dim(x, c(3,3,2)) # replicate to larger size
```

typecast	<i>Atomic and List Type Casting With Names and Dimensions Preserved</i>
----------	---

Description

Type casting usually strips away attributes of objects.

The functions provided here preserve dimensions, dimnames, and names, which may be more convenient for arrays and array-like objects.

The functions are as follows:

- `as_bool()`: converts object to atomic type logical (TRUE, FALSE, NA).
- `as_int()`: converts object to atomic type integer.
- `as_dbl()`: converts object to atomic type double (AKA numeric).
- `as_cplx()`: converts object to atomic type complex.
- `as_chr()`: converts object to atomic type character.
- `as_raw()`: converts object to atomic type raw.
- `as_list()`: converts object to recursive type list.

`as_num()` is an alias for `as_dbl()`.

`as_str()` is an alias for `as_chr()`.

See also [typeof](#).

Usage

```
as_bool(x, ...)
```

```
as_int(x, ...)
```

```
as_dbl(x, ...)
```

```
as_num(x, ...)
```

```
as_chr(x, ...)
```

```
as_str(x, ...)
```

```
as_cplx(x, ...)
```

```
as_raw(x, ...)
```

```
as_list(x, ...)
```

Arguments

<code>x</code>	an R object.
<code>...</code>	further arguments passed to or from other methods.

Value

The converted object.

Examples

```
# matrix example ====  
x <- matrix(sample(-1:28), ncol = 5)  
colnames(x) <- month.name[1:5]
```

```
rownames(x) <- month.abb[1:6]
names(x) <- c(letters[1:20], LETTERS[1:10])
print(x)
```

```
as_bool(x)
as_int(x)
as_dbl(x)
as_chr(x)
as_cplx(x)
as_raw(x)
```

```
#####
```

```
# factor example ===
x <- factor(month.abb, levels = month.abb)
names(x) <- month.name
print(x)
```

```
as_bool(as_int(x) > 6)
as_int(x)
as_dbl(x)
as_chr(x)
as_cplx(x)
as_raw(x)
```


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